ITAS191 — Lab 2

CSS I: style and the cascade

> **Time:** one class, Tuesday 9:00–2:00 · **Marks:** 20

> **Still offline, still account-free.** Your pages go live in week 6. The only websites you need are the two W3C validators — no login for either.

Work in `~/itas191/week02/`. Copy last week's resume file into it first — this week you style it, and the original stays untouched in `week01/` as your before picture.

How the day runs

Time		
9:00–9:40	**Intro A**	Three ways CSS attaches, and why external wins
9:40–10:30	**Session A — Parts 1–2**	~50 min hands-on
10:30–11:00	Break	
11:00–11:40	**Intro B**	class and id, in-page anchors, reading other sites' CSS
11:40–12:30	**Session B — Parts 3–5**	Instructor breaks for lunch around noon
12:30–2:00	**Finish + demos**	Help, then **show+tell marking** as you finish

You are marked in person. 6 of the 20 marks are for explaining your work: which rule produced which change on screen, why a selector matches what it matches, what would happen if a rule moved. A styled page you cannot explain does not earn those marks.

Part 1 — One rule, three homes · 20 min

Take one simple rule — make your resume's `h1` a colour you like — and attach it all three ways, in this order, reloading after each:

1. **Inline**: a `style="color: ..."` attribute on the `<h1>` itself.
2. **Embedded**: a `<style>` block in the `<head>`, with a proper selector:

```
css h1 { color: darkslateblue; }
```

1. **External**: create `style.css` in the same folder containing that same rule, delete the other two, and link it from the `<head>`:

```
html <link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">
```

Before you delete the inline one, try this: set a different colour in each of the three places at once, and see which one the browser obeys. That ordering — inline beats embedded beats external — is the **cascade**, and it is why this course keeps styles external: one file, one place to look, every page can share it.

Open DevTools (`F12`), click the inspect arrow, click your `h1` — the Styles panel shows every rule that applies and crosses out the losers. That panel is this week's ritual.

> **Hand in:** the resume linking `style.css`, with no inline or embedded styles left behind.

Part 2 — Style the resume · 30 min

In `style.css`, give your resume at least **six deliberate rules**:

- a `body` rule setting a background colour and a base text colour that **stay readable together** — squint test: can you read every word;
- a font choice — `font-family` with a fallback, e.g. `font-family: Georgia, serif;;`
- headings styled to look like they belong together (`h1`, `h2`);
- your `blockquote` made visibly a quotation (colour, or centred);
- **one class selector**: add `class="highlight"` to the one list item you most want the instructor to notice, and write a `.highlight` rule for it;
- one more rule of your own choosing.

Every rule must be one you can point at on screen. A rule that changes nothing visible is a rule you cannot demo.

Then validate the CSS at https://jigsaw.w3.org/css-validator/ (Direct Input) — zero errors, same habit as the HTML validator.

> **Hand in:** `style.css` and the styled resume.

Part 3 — Nanaimo Places: the content · 45 min

Download the week02 bundle from the Portal and copy the starter folder's files into `~/itas191/week02/`. Open `ITAS191_Lab2_NanaimoMap_Firstname.Lastname.html` (rename it with your own name), and open it in Firefox — you get a map of Nanaimo, a legend, and empty sections waiting for content.

One note about the starter: the top of its `<style>` block (the `box-sizing` part and the layout rules) is **provided scaffolding — leave it alone.** It uses ideas from later weeks so the page lays out nicely today. The comment in the file marks where your own styling starts.

Now the content:

1. Pick **five favourite places in Nanaimo**. New here? Five places you have found so far, or want to find — be creative.
2. Each place gets its own section in the details area: a heading carrying a **unique `id`** (`<h3 id="neck-point">Neck Point Park</h3>`), and **one detailed paragraph** — real writing, not a phrase.
3. Where you can, add a link (anchor tag) to an external page with more about the place.
4. Complete the **legend**: each legend entry is an anchor linking to the matching heading's id — `<a href="#neck-point">…</a>` — so clicking the legend jumps to the description. That `#` link is this week's new anchor trick: same tag as last week, pointing inside the page instead of out.

> **Hand in:** progress — Part 4 finishes this file.

Part 4 — Nanaimo Places: the style · 40 min

The original of this lab said it best: play around with the CSS and add your own personal style — looking at the source of other websites you like is an excellent way to learn. (DevTools on any site: inspect an element, read its rules. Learn from what you find; write your own.)

Requirements, kept from the original:

- at least **4 rules of your own in the external file** — create `nanaimo.css`, link it, and put your main styling there;
- **2 rules embedded** (in the starter's `<style>` block, below the scaffolding comment);
- **2 inline rules** on elements of your choice.

Yes, that contradicts Part 1's advice on purpose: you are doing all three modes **once, deliberately**, so you can say at the demo which rule lives where and which one wins where they collide. From week 3 on, external only.

> **Hand in:** the finished Nanaimo page and `nanaimo.css`.

Part 5 — Validate, read, polish · 20 min

1. **Both validators, both files**: HTML through https://validator.w3.org, CSS through the Jigsaw validator. Zero errors. Fix the first error first — later ones are often echoes.
2. **Click every link**: five external links, five legend jumps.

3. **Writing pass**: five real paragraphs, no placeholder text left (search the file for `[` to catch forgotten `[Firstname]` brackets).

> **Hand in:** the final files.

Marking — 20 marks

	Component	Marks
C1	The three attach modes shown; resume ends external-only	2
C2	Resume styled — six deliberate rules incl. one class, readable	4
C3	Nanaimo content — five places, ids, working legend + links	4
C4	Nanaimo style — 4 external + 2 embedded + 2 inline, personal	2
C5	Both pages validate (HTML and CSS); writing shows care	2
DU	**Demonstrates understanding** — marked in person	**6**
		20

`DU` is awarded from your show+tell demo. Expect: "which rule made this green?", "what happens if I move this rule inline?", "why did this selector catch that element?"

Submitting

Demo first, then upload your whole `week02` folder to the Portal: the styled resume + `style.css`, and the Nanaimo page + `nanaimo.css` + images.

On using AI for this lab

You may ask an AI assistant to explain — a property, a selector, a validator message you have already read. You may not use it to generate or complete the HTML or CSS you hand in, and no AI autocomplete extensions yet (assistance is permitted from week 7). One-line disclosure at the bottom of a file if you used one.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What it means	What to do
The stylesheet does nothing at all	The `<link>` is wrong — path, filename, or a missing `rel="stylesheet"`	Check the `href` spelling against the real filename; check the file sits next to the page. DevTools → Network shows a red row if it failed to load.
One rule does nothing, the rest work	Usually a missing `;` on the line above, or a missing `}` closing the previous rule	The CSS validator points at the exact line. Also: DevTools shows an ignored rule with a warning triangle.
Your `.highlight` rule does nothing	The dot: `.highlight` in CSS matches `class="highlight"` in HTML — one side is misspelled or the dot is missing	Inspect the element: does the Styles panel list your rule at all?
Changes to the CSS file don't show	The page was reloaded but the stylesheet came from cache	Ctrl + Shift + R — hard reload.
A colour comes out wildly wrong	A hex typo — `#00ff00` and `#0f0` are green, `#00f00` is invalid and gets ignored	Pick colours in DevTools: click the little colour swatch next to any colour value.
An inline style will not go away	Inline beats your stylesheet — that is the cascade working as designed	Delete the `style="…"` attribute from the tag; keep the rule in the file.
A legend link does nothing	The `href="#name"` and the heading's `id="name"` do not match exactly — ids are case-sensitive	Copy the id, paste it after the `#`.
The map or a letter image is missing	The image path or filename case does not match the real file	Filenames are case-sensitive. Keep the images next to the page, exactly as the starter shipped them.

Same rule as last week: the browser guesses, the validators name. Two validators now — you are bilingual.